

— HTTP ARCHIVE · STATE OF THE WEB

State of the Web

2020 - 2025

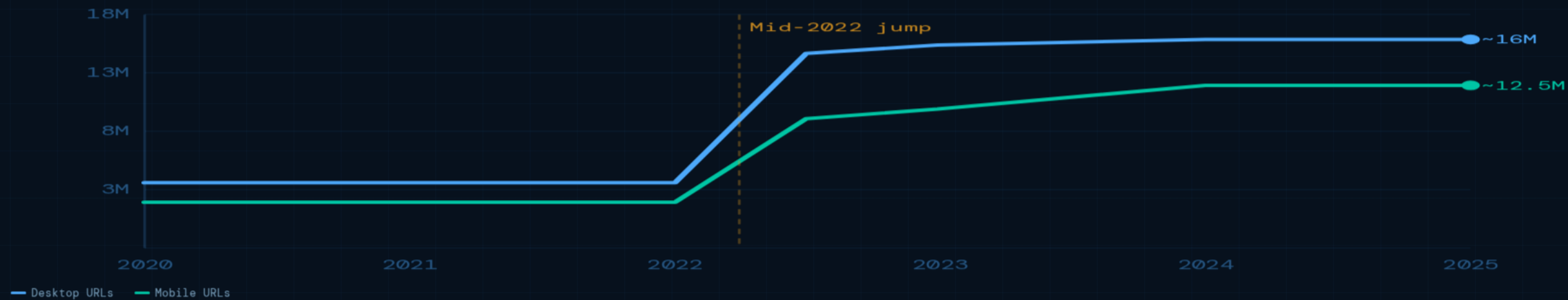
Tracking Page Weight, Protocols & Security at Scale —
HTTP Archive Trends in Transfer Size, Request Efficiency, HTTPS Adoption, and CSS
Best Practices

DATA SOURCE	TIME RANGE	COVERAGE
HTTP Archive	Jan 2020 - Mar 2026	Desktop & Mobile

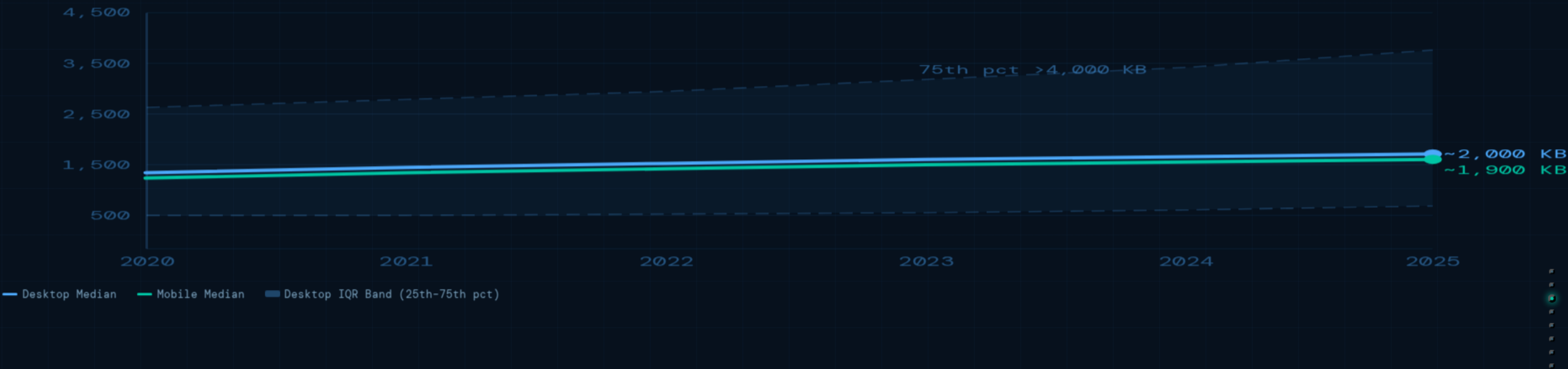
AUDIENCE
Web Perf Engineers · Front-End Architects



Crawl Sample Size **Tripled:** ·5M → 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020



Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Desktop



76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

76

Median requests/page
Desktop

▲ 2.7% since 2020

71

Median requests/page
Mobile

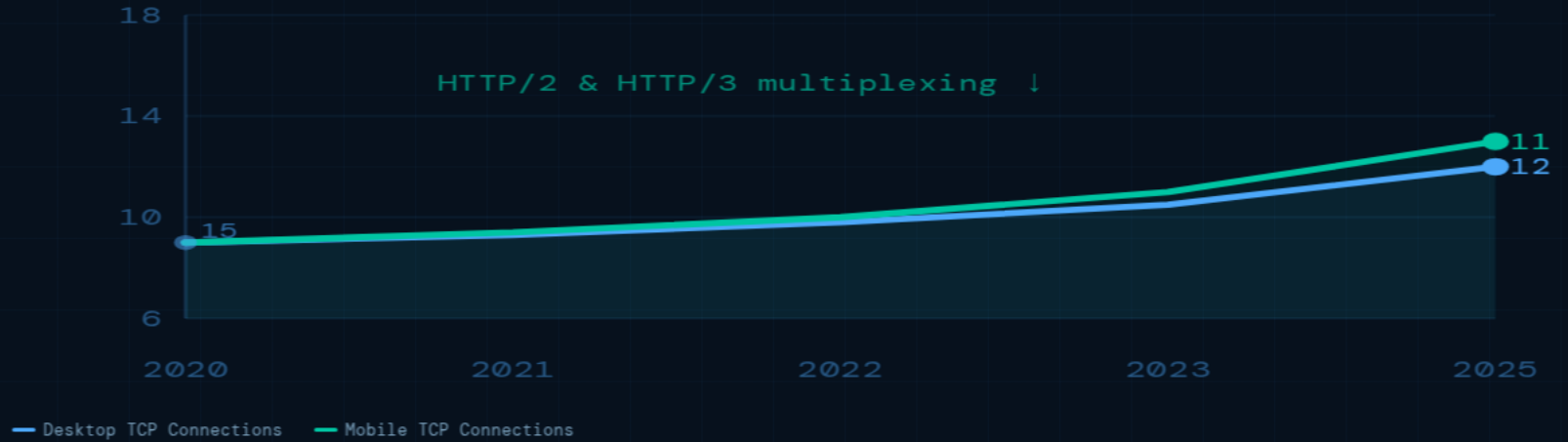
▲ 2.9% since 2020

12 / 11

TCP connections/page
Desktop / Mobile

▼ 14.3% / 26.7% - multiplexing

TCP CONNECTIONS / PAGE - MEDIAN



HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

99%+

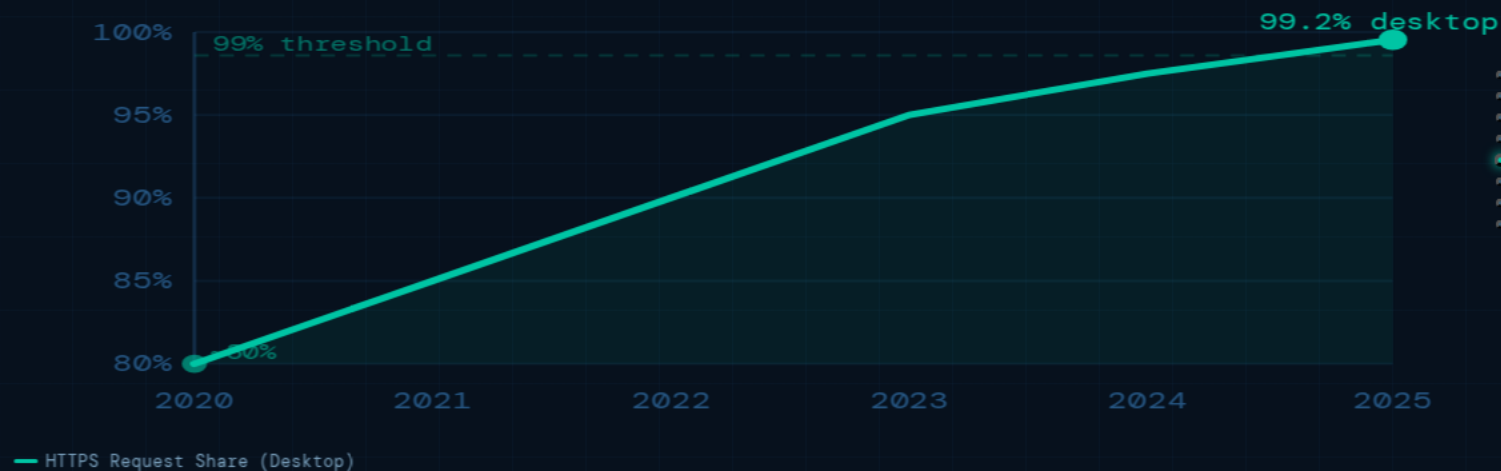
of all web requests now use HTTPS.
Plaintext HTTP is effectively extinct on the modern web.

Desktop: 99.2%

Mobile: 99.1%

Up roughly **19–20 percentage points** since early 2020, when HTTPS adoption stood at around 80%.

HTTPS REQUEST SHARE - % OF ALL REQUESTS



HTTP/2 Holds at **58%** While HTTP/3 Support Surges to **40%**

HTTP / 2 · REQUESTS

58.6%

Desktop: 58.6% · Mobile: 57.6%

Growth modest recently (1–3%) as HTTP/3 absorbs newer adoption. Now a stable baseline for most production traffic.

HTTP / 3 · SUPPORT

40%

Desktop: 38.7% · Mobile: 40.0%

Explosive growth from near-zero in 2020. Fastest-growing protocol metric in the HTTP Archive dataset.

HTTP/3 SUPPORT RISE (DESKTOP)



⚠ Measurement note: HTTP Archive measures HTTP/3 support rather than actual usage — fresh Chrome instances default to HTTP/2 on first connection before discovering HTTP/3 capability via Alt-Svc headers.

font-display Usage Reaches 42.5% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020

40.1%

Desktop pages using font-display

▲ 14.9% since 2020

42.5%

Mobile pages using font-display

▲ 61.0% since 2020

FOIT - Flash of Invisible Text

Without font-display, browsers may hide text while web fonts load. More than half of pages still risk this. Lighthouse flags the absence.

FONT-DISPLAY ADOPTION - % OF PAGES (LIGHTHOUSE)



Key Takeaways: **Bigger Pages**, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

01 - Page Weight

Median pages now transfer ~2,000 KB on desktop

Up ~25% since 2020, driven by richer media and JavaScript. The 75th-percentile desktop page exceeds 4,000 KB. Growth is moderate but unrelenting.

02 - HTTPS

HTTPS is effectively universal at 99%+

99.2% desktop / 99.1% mobile requests use HTTPS. Up ~19–20 pp from 2020. Unencrypted HTTP is now an anomaly, not a baseline.

03 - HTTP/3

HTTP/3 is the fastest-growing protocol metric

From near-zero to ~38–40% support in under four years. HTTP/2 holds stable at ~58%. HTTP/3 is rapidly becoming mainstream infrastructure.

04 - Connections

TCP connections fell 15–27% despite rising requests

Multiplexing in HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 cut median connections from ~15 to 12 (desktop) and 11 (mobile). Efficiency gains are real and measurable.

05 - font-display

Font-display still has significant room to grow

Only 40.1% desktop / 42.5% mobile pages use font-display. More than half still risk Flash of Invisible Text on font load.

CALL TO ACTION



Benchmark your own sites against these baselines: page weight < 2,000 KB median, HTTPS at 100%, HTTP/2+ enabled, TCP connections < 12, and font-display on all web fonts.